

Element A

A1: The janitors need a solution to keep the trash bags from falling into the trash can. It causes trash to pile up inside the bin, but outside the bag, and also causes it to fall out of the trash bin. This makes them have to do more work, having to reach for the extra trash and pick it up, which is unsanitary. Not to mention the mess and smells that it creates.

A2: A trash bag falling out of a trash can is a common problem occurring in households and public places every day. The reason is that the trash bag slips off the corners of the trash can and falls down into the trash. The trash bags aren't strong enough to hold onto the corners of the trashcans and slip down due to this. The weight of the trash in the trash bags pulls down and causes tension on the trash can. Without a good enough hold or grip the bag will slip down. In the problem the people who own the trashcan are involved, they put the trash bag into the trashcan and attach it to the edges of the can. This happens in households or public locations. This happens pretty frequently and is a pretty big issue for many people.

A3: This problem involves two main stakeholders. The first stakeholder are the janitors. They are involved because the problem affects their job, by making them stop to clean up the mess. Solving this problem would make their jobs easier and make them not have to stop and fix the trash can. The second stakeholder who is involved in the problem are the students at the school. This problem affects the students because it causes a mess in the cafeteria and classrooms that they have to deal with. The trash bag falling can lead to an unsanitary workspace. Solving this problem would overall improve the quality of life that students have in school.

A4: This problem's primary stakeholders are the janitors since they have to deal with the problem of the trash bags falling down and they have to clean up the mess. The secondary stakeholders are the students and teachers because they might not be able to throw their trash away because the trash bag fell down into the trash can, this can make the school very unsanitary.

A5: This problem happens when the janitors are cleaning the cafeteria, when students are throwing away their trash, when people are cleaning up classrooms, your kitchen or when you're decluttering and throwing things away. When things pile up in the trash can it starts to weigh the bag down a lot. And when doing things like this, that can cause the bag to fall off the rim of the trash can very often. This happens daily because these situations occur everyday.

A6: It's important to solve the problem with accurate measurable data to make sure that the product works as intended. Things like how big the device will be and how long it's meant to last affect the efficiency of the product.

Element B

B1: This problem has had prior attempts. Tying a knot around the trash bag to keep the trash bag tight has been attempted. Although this attempt has worked, many problems can and have arisen from it. The knot can easily come undone and make for the trash bag to become loose. The knot is a cheap and simple way of fixing the problem that does not require outside elements but does come with some flaws that make for an outside element or solution to work better.

B2: Previous attempts to solve this problem included tying a knot around the trash can which proved to work well. However, this solution is not permanent and cannot be used every time to fully solve the problem.